

K-Pop Duo V8 Drops Debut EP with Pharrell!

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If you love **K-pop**, get ready for something new! Two members of the famous group SEVENTEEN The 8 and Vernon have formed a **sub-unit** called V8. They're releasing their first mini-album (called an **EP**) on June 29. And guess what? Superstar producer Pharrell Williams helped make some of the songs! Pharrell is the guy who sang "Happy" and produced for tons of big artists. The **EP** is all about "**wasted youth**" those messy, confusing times when you're growing up. But instead of being sad about it, the songs turn that energy into something powerful and free. The duo teased the album with a grainy 30-second video. In it, they're lounging in an apartment, throwing food at each other, and dancing through fireworks in front of a billboard. It looks super fun! Besides Pharrell, the **EP** has lots of other cool **producers**, like Dylan Brady from 100 gecs and Mechatok, a German DJ. There are also Korean **producers** like KIRARA and BUMZU, who has worked with SEVENTEEN before. The list of **producers** was revealed in a clever video where names burned in reverse. V8's music sounds like **hyperpop** a fast, colorful, electronic style. If you're into SEVENTEEN or just want fresh, exciting music, mark June 29 on your calendar!

Word Treasure

K-pop -- A style of pop music from South Korea that is known for catchy songs and energetic dances.

EP -- Short for 'Extended Play', a collection of a few songs that is longer than a single but shorter than a full album.

sub-unit -- A smaller group made up of some members from a bigger band, often making different music.

producers -- People who help create and shape songs by working on beats, sounds, and the style of the music.

hyperpop -- A genre of music with fast beats, high-pitched sounds, and colorful electronic effects.

wasted youth -- A phrase describing the messy, confusing time when you are growing up, often used in art and music.

Background you need

K-pop is a type of exciting music from South Korea that has become extremely popular around the world, with groups like BTS and BLACKPINK.

SEVENTEEN (a 13-member boy band from South Korea) is known for its catchy songs and amazing dance routines.

Pharrell Williams (an American musician who sang the cheerful song 'Happy') often works with other artists to create fresh sounds.

Break it down

WHO: V8, a sub-unit of SEVENTEEN featuring The 8 and Vernon.

WHAT: Their first mini-album (EP) will be released, co-produced by Pharrell Williams.

WHERE: The release will be worldwide on music streaming platforms.

WHY: Because they want to express the messy energy of wasted youth and show a new, powerful side of themselves.

Why it matters

V8's EP shows how music can turn confusing feelings into something fun and creative, and it might inspire you to explore your own emotions through art, dance, or writing.

Test what you remember

1. What is V8?

- ☐ (A) A new boy band
- ☐ (B) A sub-unit of SEVENTEEN
- ☐ (C) A record label
- ☐ (D) A video game

2. Which famous producer helped make songs for the EP?

- ☐ (A) BUMZU
- ☐ (B) Pharrell Williams
- ☐ (C) Dylan Brady
- ☐ (D) Mechatok

3. What is the main theme of the EP?

- ☐ (A) Love and romance
- ☐ (B) Fantasy adventures
- ☐ (C) Wasted youth
- ☐ (D) Space travel

4. What music style does V8's music sound like?

- ☐ (A) Rock
- ☐ (B) Ballad
- ☐ (C) Hyperpop
- ☐ (D) Country

5. When will V8's first EP be released?

- ☐ (A) June 29
- ☐ (B) July 4
- ☐ (C) August 15
- ☐ (D) May 20

6. Which two SEVENTEEN members form V8?

- ☐ (A) S.Coups and Wonwoo
- ☐ (B) The 8 and Vernon
- ☐ (C) DK and Joshua
- ☐ (D) Hoshi and Dino

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: B 3: C 4: C 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

1. **Excited fan:** Fans of SEVENTEEN are thrilled to see members try a new style and work with a legendary producer like Pharrell. It feels fresh and creative.
2. **Skeptical:** Some people think sub-units are just a way to sell more albums, and that bringing in many famous producers might cover up the members' own ideas rather than showing their real talent.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):